

ASIA

The vast continent of Asia is dominated by two giant nations—China and India, each with more than a billion people and a rich and colorful history. Both are being transformed by rapid economic growth, and so are many other Asian countries, listed below in order of size. Yet in some regions of central Asia life has barely changed in a thousand years.

China  3,705,407 sq miles 9,596,960 sq km 1,373,541,000 Beijing Mandarin, Wu, Cantonese, Hsiang, Min, Hakka, Kan	Iran  636,368 sq miles 1,648,195 sq km 82,801,600 Tehran Farsi, Azeri, Luri, Gilaki, Mazandarani, Kurdish, Turkmen, Arabic, Balochi	Afghanistan  251,826 sq miles 652,230 sq km 33,332,000 Kabul Pashto, Tajik, Dari, Farsi, Uzbek, Turkmen	Iraq  169,234 sq miles 438,317 sq km 38,146,000 Baghdad Arabic, Kurdish, Turkic languages, Armenian, Assyrian	Philippines  115,830 sq miles 300,000 sq km 102,624,000 Manila Filipino, English, Tagalog, Cebuano, Ilocano, Hiligaynon, many other local languages	Nepal  56,827 sq miles 147,181 sq km 29,034,000 Kathmandu Nepali, Maithili, Bhojpuri
India  1,269,212 sq miles 3,287,263 sq km 1,266,884,000 New Delhi Hindi, English, Urdu, Bengali, Marathi, Telugu, Tamil, Bihari, Gujarati, Kannada	Mongolia  603,905 sq miles 1,564,116 sq km 3,031,000 Ulaanbaatar Khalkha Mongolian, Kazakh, Chinese, Russian	Yemen  203,848 sq miles 527,968 sq km 27,393,000 Sanaak Arabic	Japan  145,913 sq miles 377,915 sq km 126,702,000 Tokyo Japanese, Korean, Chinese	Laos  91,428 sq miles 236,800 sq km 7,019,000 Vientiane Lao, Mon-Khmer, Yao, Vietnamese, Chinese, French	Bangladesh  55,598 sq miles 143,998 sq km 156,187,000 Dhaka Bengali, Urdu, Chakma, Marma (Magh), Garo, Khasi, Santhali, Tripura, Mru
Kazakhstan  1,052,084 sq miles 2,724,900 sq km 18,360,000 Astana Kazakh, Russian, Ukrainian, German, Uzbek, Tatar, Uyghur	Pakistan  307,372 sq miles 796,095 sq km 201,956,000 Islamabad Punjabi, Sindhi, Pashtu, Urdu, Balochi, Brahui	Thailand  198,116 sq miles 513,120 sq km 68,201,000 Bangkok Thai, Chinese, Malay, Khmer, Mon, Karen, Miao	Vietnam  127,880 sq miles 331,210 sq km 95,261,000 Hanoi Vietnamese, Chinese, Thai, Khmer, Muong, Nung, Miao, Yao, Jari	Kyrgyzstan  77,201 sq miles 199,951 sq km 5,728,000 Bishkek Kyrgyz, Russian, Uzbek, Tatar, Ukrainian	Tajikistan  55,251 sq miles 143,100 sq km 8,331,000 Dushanbe Tajik, Uzbek, Russian
Saudi Arabia  829,995 sq miles 2,149,690 sq km 28,160,000 Riyadh Arabic	Turkey  302,533 sq miles 783,562 sq km 80,275,000 Ankara Turkish, Kurdish, Arabic, Circassian, Armenian, Greek, Georgian, Ladino (Judeo-Spanish)	Turkmenistan  188,455 sq miles 488,100 sq km 5,291,000 Ashgabat Turkmen, Uzbek, Russian, Kazakh, Tatar	Malaysia  127,354 sq miles 329,847 sq km 30,950,000 Kuala Lumpur Bahasa Malaysia, Malay, Chinese, Tamil, English	Syria  71,498 sq miles 185,180 sq km 17,185,000 Damascus Arabic, French, Kurdish, Armenian, Circassian, Turkic languages, Assyrian, Aramaic	North Korea  46,540 sq miles 120,538 sq km 25,115,000 Pyongyang Korean
Indonesia  735,354 sq miles 1,904,569 sq km 258,316,000 Jakarta Javanese, Sundanese, Madurese, Bahasa Indonesia, Dutch	Myanmar (Burma)  261,227 sq miles 676,578 sq km 56,890,000 Nay Pyi Taw Burmese, Shan, Karen, Rakhine (Arakanese), Chin, Yangbye, Kachin, Mon	Uzbekistan  172,741 sq miles 447,400 sq km 29,474,000 Tashkent Uzbek, Russian, Tajik, Kazakh	Oman  119,498 sq miles 309,500 sq km 3,355,000 Muscat Arabic, Balochi, Farsi, Hindi, Punjabi	Cambodia  69,898 sq miles 181,035 sq km 15,957,000 Phnom Penh Khmer, French, Chinese, Vietnamese, Cham	South Korea  38,502 sq miles 99,720 sq km 50,924,000 Seoul Korean